FAIRagro

Data Management Plan

What is a data management plan (DMP)?



- A DMP is a **living document**
- It is created **at the beginning** of a research project
- It is **updated regularly** as the project progresses
- It defines the **strategy for managing, storing, documenting, and sharing** research data

What ? **How** ? **Who** ?

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Importance of DMPs



- **Saving time** for your future self.
- Identifying **time** and **money costs** to be included in the proposal.



- Regulate **access rights** and preventing **security holes**.
- Facilitating **data reuse**.
- Ensuring **ethical** and **legal requirements** are fulfilled.



- Enabling **verification** and **control**.
- Supporting **research integrity**.
- Part of the **funder requirements**.

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Funder Requirements

Funder	Requirements	Submit with proposal	Content	Update	Link
EC Horizon 2020	**DMP**	No; first plan is needed within the first **6 months** of the project.	According to H2020 Template	Yes, in case of significant changes **and** end of the project.	Online Manual
DFG	Information about **handling with scientific data**	**Yes**	According to the DFG Codex on Data Management	No	Principles of DFG Funding
BMBF	Depending on the project	Yes (depending on the project)	Depending on the project	Depending on the project	Aktionsplan Forschungsdaten

Source: Daniel Wibberg, Helena Schnitzer (de.NBi) and RDMkit modified by FAIRagro 2025

Content of a Data Management Plan (DMP)



Documentation and metadata



Secure storage and backup



Data sharing



Publication



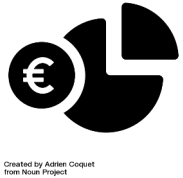
Reusable data



Digital preservation and deletion



Legal aspects



Costs and resources

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Creating a Data Management Plan



What to consider?

- Define clear responsibilities
- Follow relevant guidelines and standards (depending on your institution or funder)
- Use helpful DMP templates and tools
- Get support from experts:
  - IT department
  - Library or data managers
  - Data protection officers
  - Research Data Service of the University/institution
  - Helpdesk of the FAIRagro Data Steward Service Centre
  - etc.

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